

Thrilling Stories of the Sky Trails

Air STORIES

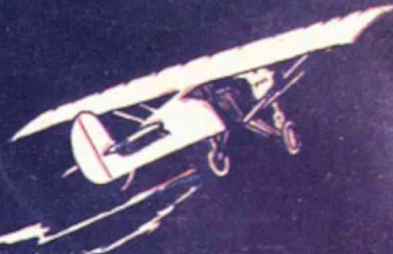


August 20¢

Jerry
the Hawk
*the gripping story
of a sky crasher*
by Arthur J. Burks

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Title: How to get an air job

Author: Jack Byrne

Release date: August 1, 2023 [eBook #71315]

Most recently updated: July 18, 2024

Language: English

Original publication: New York: Fiction House, Inc., 1927

Other information and formats: www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/71315

Credits: Roger Frank

*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK HOW TO GET
AN AIR JOB ***

How to Get



An Air Job

HOW TO GET AN AIR JOB

By Jack Byrne

If you have the nerve and ambition to become a cloudman, this will tell you where to go to bat—and how.

Back in the days when the clipper ships spread their great, white sails from Hudson's Bay clear down around the Horn, the youth of America heard the call of the sea—the whistle of a hurricane through the shrouds, the *boom, boom, boom* of the surf pounding a coral shore. They heard the call and they answered it; and with their youth and their strength and their undying courage they toiled till their new flag ruled the seas.

Then came the call of the West. The pioneer spirit that was Kit Carson's, that was Boone's, reached out through the land. Clerks put down their pens and joined the wagon trains; farmers gave up the plows to strap on their muskets. From every walk in life they came to battle with their wilderness. And they stretched their homes from coast to coast to rule the land.

The sea, first; then the land. And now they have come to that last great frontier—the air!

The advance man has made toward his conquest of the air is common knowledge. The development of heavier-than-air craft from a purely experimental stage to its present place in the commercial world has been a part of our lives; in a sense, we have all grown up with it. We have come naturally to recognize aviation as one of the prime factors of the future—and the same pioneer spirit that conquered the land and the sea is impelling our young men to ask questions about it.

“Does aviation offer *me* an opportunity?” they want to know. And then they ask, “How can I take advantage of this opportunity? How can I learn aviation and get a job in the air?”

The answer to the first question is emphatically, YES! American aviation today has reached a good sound beginning. The countries of Europe may boast more widespread routes, may point to their greater number of planes and a greater volume of business, but experts now declare unanimously that

this condition is only temporary. The United States has solved its air problem in typical Yankee style—and our unsubsidized, privately-owned companies form a solid basis upon which to build.

You, if you have certain definite qualifications, can help in the building.

The qualifications are simple and concise. They are:

- (1) Good health and a strong body.
- (2) A common-school education, or better.
- (3) An interest in mechanics and a flair for adventure.

If you have these things, and with them an impelling desire to pioneer in a virgin field, aviation offers you an opportunity to get in on the ground floor. Of course, everyone cannot be a pilot or a flyer any more than every man on the baseball team can be the pitcher. For every person in the air there must be at least ten men doing work on the ground, and many of you will find your opportunity there.

Aircraft companies will need Aeronautical Engineers, Mechanics, Motor Experts, Airplane Builders and Designers, Assemblers, Salesmen—and as the industry develops the need for men trained in this field will increase, just as it did in the automotive industry. And aviation is growing by leaps and bounds.

The second question—how to learn aviation and get a job in the flying game—is more complex and more difficult to answer. It would be best to divide the answer in two parts; (1) for the fellow who can afford to take a course in aviation instruction; and (2) for the fellow who has to make his way while he learns.

If you have between \$500.00 and \$1,000.00 dollars to spend, you can take a complete training in the theory and practice of aviation; and with this training you should be able to get a job that will repay your investment—and with interest. There are hundreds of schools and private operators who can teach you the business of flying. Several of our leading colleges offer technical courses for more advanced students. There are even organizations that offer courses in aeronautics by correspondence. The prospective student has a wide choice.

Air Stories will be glad to help you in the selection of a school to meet your own requirements if you say the word.

If you have to make your way while you learn, you might well consider the chance that is offered young men interested in aviation by the United

States Army Air Corps.

The soldiers of the Army Air Corps are offered intensive courses which not only qualify them for specialists' ratings and higher non-commissioned officer grades, but also give them a training that should enable them to make their way in commercial aviation after their enlistment is expired. There is also the opportunity for soldiers to gain appointment as Flying Cadets. The Flying Cadet's course qualifies the student as an expert pilot. At the conclusion of this course the student is honorably discharged from the Army and becomes eligible to take examination for an officer's commission in the Reserve Corps.

A typical example of the aeronautical training the Air Corps offers are the courses given by the Air Service Technical School at Chanute Field, Illinois. These courses are given to specially selected enlisted men and to recruits who are sent to the school before they are assigned to units. There are no hard and fast rules governing the entrance requirements, except, perhaps, the three primary qualifications we mentioned before. The School is divided in three departments: one of photography, one of communication, and one of mechanics.

The department of photography has been in operation for five years and is conducted under the most advanced methods. Opportunities in aerial photography are unlimited, both in the military and commercial sense. The work is interesting, varying as it does from the operation of motion picture cameras to photographing large sections of the United States and assembling the hundreds of pictures thus taken into maps. Men trained in this work are needed in war times to map enemy territory in the same manner. In times of peace the aerial photographer is offered many chances for employment by the fact that these aerial maps are displacing blueprints in a great number of engineering projects. An aerial survey was recently taken of Chicago's lake front. Stretches of land that are heavily covered with undergrowth are practically all being surveyed from the air.

The course in the communications department consists of training for radio mechanics and operators. The use of radio in connection with aviation is gradually assuming greater importance in the commercial field since machines capable of making long ocean flights have been developed. It has always been of prime importance in warfare. Candidates for this course should be interested in radio work, have at least three years in high school or its equivalent, and, though not necessary, training or experience in any of

the following lines is desirable:—radio operator, commercial telegrapher or electrician.

The department of mechanics offers training in a number of subjects, such as airplane and auto mechanics, aircraft armorers, and in the construction, repair and inspection of airplanes. This is considered the most important course since airplanes depend on their mechanical well-being. Requirements are a common-school education or its equivalent and some experience in a line similar to the course taken.

These three courses all last about twenty-four weeks. In the first two courses, new classes begin every month; in the mechanics course, every second month. Chanute Field is located at Rantoul, Illinois, 114 miles south of Chicago. The training offered at this field is just an example of the training offered at the many other Air Corps schools. *Air Stories* will furnish further information in regard to these schools at your request.

If you can't afford the aviation school and the Army Air Corps doesn't appeal to you, then the only thing left to do is to hunt a job with an air-transport company or with some organization engaged in the manufacture of airplane parts and accessories. This way might be called the "back-door to aviation."

The "back-door" isn't the pleasantest way in the world to get in, but the fact that some of the biggest names in present-day aviation made their start this way, proves that it can be done. They learned the game from the ground up, started at the very bottom of the ladder—and what one man has done can be done again, if you've got the stuff.

When you consider the number of organizations operating commercial air routes, the increasing number of companies engaged in the manufacture of airplane parts, the widespread number of smaller companies engaged in aviation, it is easy to understand that there is a chance at the bottom of the ladder now. And the industry is growing so rapidly that every day sees that chance assuming larger proportions.

You want to appreciate right now, though, that getting a job in the air is a mighty tough proposition for the inexperienced man—the same tough proposition that the inexperienced man faces in any line of work. The only solution is to keep on trying and keep on fighting until you do get a job.

Go to some airplane manufacturing company or to some company engaged in commercial flying and try to break in with them. Take anything.

Start as a janitor or a painter or an office boy—start at anything as long as you *start*! If you have the qualifications we noted before, and you have the desire to get in the air, you can *make* your job take you wherever you want to go.

Men aren't born into bank presidents' jobs; they fight their way up to them. It's the same in aviation as it is in any other game.

Transcriber's Note: This story appeared in the August 1927 issue of *Air Stories* magazine.

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK HOW TO GET AN
AIR JOB ***

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